

1. I'm starting HomelabFest (in St. Louis, Sep 2027)

Source: Jeff Geerling | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 10:16:00 -0500

Link: <https://www.jeffgeerling.com/blog/2026/homelabfest-announcement/>

I've been working on my homelab for years, and I enjoy sharing what I learn through this blog and my YouTube channel. Over the past few years, I realized the homelab community (which isn't really a defined thing?that's okay) hasn't had its own gathering, the way makers, software engineers, embedded developers, and HPC professionals do. There are many events that have crossover into the homelab realm, but nothing focused on energy-efficient servers, privacy-respecting self-hosted software, keeping old hardware useful, or cable management and rackmounting on a budget.

2. Quoting John Gruber

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-25T17:22:01+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/25/john-gruber/>

Muse is getting a lot of attention ? including mine ? because it?s both groundbreaking technically (each user gets their own entire persistent Linux VM running in Meta?s cloud) and because it?s packaged in an easy-to-install easy-to-use way. It?s literally presented as a cute mascot . It?s the first consumer-accessible agentic AI system, and Meta has truly done an amazing job with that. But it?s a genuinely open question whether consumers have any understanding what this means. If you buy a power saw that can cut your fingers off, you are almost certainly aware that you are buying a power saw that can sever your fingers. [...] I don?t think people realize how powerful ? and thus dangerous ? Muse is, especially if it?s running on your Mac. ? John Gruber , Muse Looks Cute, but Looks are Deceiving Tags: meta , ai , llms , general-agents , generative-ai , john-gruber , muse-agent , muse

3. Northern Gannet, Great Blue Heron, California Brown Pelican

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-25T02:07:04+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/25/sighting-403293902/>

Northern Gannet, Great Blue Heron, California Brown Pelican, in Monterey Bay National Marine Sanctuary, CA, US, CA New 200-800mm Canon EF lens got me my best photo of Morris yet. They really like hanging out under that sign in the harbor! Tags: photography , wildlife

4. Note on 24th September 2026

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-09-24T23:31:08+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Sep/24/harder/>

The more time I spend working with coding agents, the more convinced I am that they make software engineering even harder. We can do amazing things with them, but unlocking their full potential requires extraordinary discipline and knowledge. Tags: coding-agents , ai , llms

5. U.S. Soldier Gets 70 Months in Prison for AT&T, Verizon Extortions

Source: Krebs on Security | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 21:44:40 +0000

Link: <https://krebsonsecurity.com/2026/09/u-s-soldier-gets-70-months-in-prison-for-att-verizon-extortions/>

A U.S. Army soldier who pleaded guilty to hacking into multiple telecommunications companies and stealing mobile call and text metadata for more than 100 million AT&T customers in 2024 was sentenced to 70 months in federal prison today and ordered to pay nearly \$300,000 in restitution to victims.

6. Mr. Choyka Is Apparently Doing Well

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-25T23:50:45Z

Link: <https://www.usatoday.com/story/sports/golf/2020/02/02/golf-amateur-gary-choyka-sinks-two-holes-one-same-round/4639969002/>

A reader asked if this Gary Choyka who hit two holes-in-one in the same round of golf back in 2020 is the same Gary Choyka who was my history teacher 30+ years ago. Indeed it is. He looks good. (He was a hell of a basketball player too.) ?

7. Stock UI in MacOS 27 Eschews Clarity

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-25T20:54:34Z

Link: <https://mastodon.design/@thibault/117320401426286497>

?Thibault?, in post on Mastodon responding to Brent Simmons?s ?stock Mac UI? post that I just linked to : It reminded me of my own explorations with the macOS design language, especially the modern title/toolbar which I believe is one of the most foundational design regression on the platform. I played with the idea of redesigning the Finder with the original hierarchy but keeping the current Liquid Glass styling. Though it?s still far from what I?d like to see on my Mac, I thought I?d share. Here?s his subtle mockup: The changes in Thibault?s redesign, if you describe them verbally, sound minor. But looking at the differences feels like a huge ? and much needed ? breath of fresh air. It relaxes my nervous system to see obvious differentiation for window chrome at the top. The hierarchy is clear: this area is the window, this area is the content of the window. Apple?s MacOS 27 Golden Gate stock UI deliberately does away with that differentiation, for no good reason. I crave clarity, and Apple?s current MacOS design language rejects clarity. Like: where exactly can you click to drag a window around? That ought to be obvious; instead it?s literally a guessing game. And Thibault?s si...

8. Brent Simmons on ?Stock? Mac UI

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-09-25T19:45:44Z

Link: <https://inessential.com/2026/09/22/that-about-wraps-it-up-for.html>

Brent Simmons: To recap: the reasons for using stock Mac UI are 1) user familiarity, which we?ve known for a while just isn?t a thing, and 2) hoping to be able to expend less developer effort, which we?ve seen can work against you. But there?s another reason: the stock Mac UI is designed by Apple, the best designers in the world, and do you really think you can do better? Really? The app world is full of people who think they?re better and they?re really, really, really not. Well, I still think Apple has the best collection of UI designers in the world, but, for whatever reasons, the guidance from above on how the Mac UI should look is missing the mark. I?m not blaming the people doing the work ? they?re doing great work with the direction they?re given. So this ? bad direction ? is where the secret third reason falls down. And we?re left with no real reason to stick with stock Mac UI (except for wanting approval from longtime Mac people like me, and you really shouldn?t care about that at all). I was hesitant to quote anything from Simmons?s post, because you really ought to read the whole thing . (I?ve always loved the way Brent writes.) But I really like his emphasis throughout...

9. Debugging walkthrough: Access violation on nonsense instruction, episode 3

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260925-00/?p=112731/>

Trying to figure out what the interloper was trying to. The post Debugging walkthrough: Access violation on nonsense instruction, episode 3 appeared first on The Old New Thing .

10. Advice to a beginning software engineer

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Sat, 26 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/advice-to-a-beginning-software-engineer/>

In general, you should be suspicious of engineers who are trying to give you advice. Even during ordinary times, this industry is so wide and changes so quickly that nobody really knows anything for sure. And we are not in ordinary times. The advent of LLMs and AI agents is the largest change to software engineering in my professional lifetime, and possibly the largest change ever. That said, here?s my advice: Don?t trust senior engineers who are telling you to pick political fights Don?t play games. Keep your head down and be helpful Be conscientious and try hard to actually understand what you?re working on Don?t panic about AI, and don?t delegate your judgement to it Don?t avoid AI ? keep thinking! Don?t lose hope Don?t trust ZIRP-era

advice Most experienced software engineers today have spent the bulk of their career in the ZIRP era . This was a time when investment money flooded the industry, driving up engineer bargaining power. Big tech companies spent a lot of money and effort trying to make their engineers happy and comfortable. If you were an engineer at one of those companies, you could expect to have a decent say in what kind of work you did, and even what kind of poli...

11. You should all be asking way more questions

Source: seangoedecke.com RSS feed | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://seangoedecke.com/you-should-all-be-asking-way-more-questions/>

When someone is explaining something to me, I ask on average one question every thirty seconds. I'm sure this is frustrating to some people, but it's actually a good habit and you should do it too. Trying to understand Most of the questions I ask are very short, and require very short answers. Typically I'm asking for confirmation: "so when you say X, you mean Y?", or "this X is the thing you mentioned earlier when you were saying Z?". The point of these questions is to make sure I understand. A small misunderstanding early on balloons into a big misunderstanding later, because all the things you misinterpret based on the first misunderstanding will become misunderstandings in their own right, and so on. That's why you can't just wait until someone's finished talking and ask all your questions at once 1 . I think most people don't ask questions because they're not really trying to understand: they're happy to just trust that the person they're talking to knows what's going on. This goes double when that person is a well-respected or more senior engineer. However, once you have skin in the game , that all changes. When you're in a position where you are the one responsible for succ...

12. Servers in dawn-dusk orbit

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 11:45:31 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/09/25/dawn-dusk-orbit/>

Despite the predictions that no one would ever put build data centers in space, Google is starting on Thursday. Google's prototype satellite will be one of 130 payloads on SpaceX's Transporter 18 mission on October 1. The server will follow a dawn-dusk orbit, a special case of a sun-synchronous orbit (SSO), following the terminator line [?] The post Servers in dawn-dusk orbit first appeared on John D. Cook .

13. Premium: The Hater's Guide To AI Debt (Part 2)

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 14:25:21 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-the-haters-guide-to-ai-debt-part-2/>

The year is 2026, and you are a hyperscaler CEO. You zip up your Patagonia Vest, type UPDATE CALENDER WHERE WHY to your Muse agent, and it tells you that your CFO has sent you an email about something called a "critical finance meeting," and you roll your

14. Using an LLM to Automate the Process of Archiving New macOS App Icons

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/faster-app-icon-retrieval/>

Whenever a new version of macOS drops, I find myself archiving the new app icons for my macOS icon gallery . In the past, the work to do this was a bit tedious. First, I'd find the app in the "Applications" folder (or elsewhere on the Mac), right click and choose "Get Info". Right-click the app icon in the Get Info pane and choose "Copy": Open the Preview app and go "File -> New from Clipboard": This gets me the app icon file with a variety of sizes (the 1024-pixel version is the one I want). From here, I go "File -> Export", choose "PNG", and name the file as the app name, lowercased, hyphenated "e.g. "app-store.png" (I do this for automation purposes not relevant here). Doing that for every Apple-supplied app in the OS can get tiring. It's often upwards of 75+ icons. "This seems like the perfect task for an LLM," I thought. So I hastily wrote a prompt to see if it could do it. And it did "sort of, after a little coaching. On the first try it found an app's .icns file, grabbed the 256x256 version, upscaled it to 1024x1024, and saved it. So I scolded it, "No, no. NEVER upscale an image. Always find the biggest one. I can get the 1024 version myself from the "Get info" pane, so...

15. This Week on The Analog Antiquarian

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 14:02:16 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/09/this-week-on-the-analog-antiquarian/>

The Tudor Queens Also, a little programming note: there will go one extra week between this article on The Analog Antiquarian and the next one on The Digital Antiquarian. Just the usual excuses: a holiday and a five-Friday month.

16. AI Killed the MVP ? Long Live the IUP

Source: Steve Blank | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 13:00:16 +0000

Link: <https://steveblank.com/2026/09/25/ai-killed-the-mvp-long-live-the-iup/>

This post previously appeared in Poets and Quants This is the second of four posts on how AI has impacted our Lean LaunchPad class and what we did about it. Part 1: The Year AI Came For Us Part 2: This Post Next Week Part 3: The World Outside the Classroom Changed, The Class Didn't [?]

17. I'm Tired of Being on the Network

Source: matduggan.com | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 12:00:44 GMT

Link: <https://matduggan.com/im-tired-of-being-on-the-network/>

You can tell how tired someone is of the always-online life pretty easily. When they get home, watch the distance between the phone and the body. The people who love being connected never let the thing leave them be it pocket, palm, face-down next to the fork. Everyone

18. Pluralistic: Itch scratching (25 Sep 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 25 Sep 2026 18:56:20 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/09/25/other-people/>

Today's links Itch scratching: Love, care and self-actualization. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: 9/11 x Viridians; Announcing Wikipedia; Infinite Copyright Mickey; Floppy shoulder bag; Wells Fargo's long sleaze; Corbyn wins Labour leadership; Interop v internet monopolies; The billionaires aren't all right; RIP Mike Ford; PGP didn't cause 9/11; Flying Solaris boxen; "Unelectable" Corbyn; Algorithmic management; "That's Disgusting!"; Tax breaks for repair expenses; Climate denial driven by economic doctrine; "100% pumpkin" has no pumpkin; Copyright reversion; "Scholars of the Night"; Apple threatens EU. Upcoming appearances: Edmonton, Boston, Brighton, South Bend, Hudson, Calgary, Winnipeg, Paris, Vancouver, Victoria, Ottawa, Kilkenny, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Itch scratching (permalink) The thing about a maddening itch between your shoulder blades is that it feels so good when you scratch it, and even better when someone else scratches it, and better still if that person hits the right spot because...